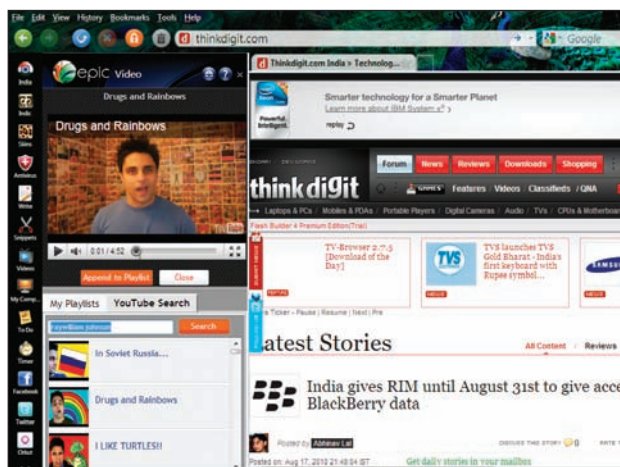


World view

We present the global take on technology. Now there's nothing you'll ever miss!

Lightpeak

A peak at Intel's research that could change your life in the near future



Watching videos in Epic while browsing the latest news stories

representing every Indian state and every aspect of Indian culture and finally India content sidebar with the latest news from all over the world and the nation from multiple publications, regional

languages as effortlessly as English speakers. Epic is the first browser that enables all Indians, especially non-English-speaking Indians, to come online and share their thoughts and ideas (our 12 languages still

	IE 8.0.7	Chrome 5.0.3	Opera 10.60	Firefox 3.6.8	Flock 2.6.1	Epic 1.1
Startup (in secs)	3.77	4.5	2.26	5.32	3.69	4.62
Memory (single tab)	75332	63236	102884	48460	91760	68392
Memory (4 tabs)	192640	169844	191412	101412	121504	124592
Acid3	Fail	94	100	94	72	92

news in regional languages and English, live cricket scores and commentary, top music albums, live television and more.

The browser is fully geared towards



Skins Sidebar App

India and hence has a host of India specific apps and content delivered. Besides, this there is the in-built Indic languages transliteration support. "One key inspiration for India was to develop a tool that could help Indian language conversation and discourse move online. At present, almost all Indian internet activity has been in English but with Epic, Indian language speakers can share their thoughts and ideas online in Indian lan-

guages as effortlessly as English speakers. don't cover all of India but a large, large portion!)" says Alok.

Epic's Indic Language support is built on the Firefox add-on Google Transliteration which derives its name from the fact that it uses the Google Indic transliteration API. So basically the backend is powered by the Google Indic transliteration API, and the frontend is a combination of the Google Transliteration add-on for Firefox by a brilliant developer out of Chennai Sridhar with a lot of modification by the Epic team.

Security

Epic may very well be the first browser to integrate an AV suite. In built anti-virus includes on-demand anti-virus scanning which can scan your whole computer system for viruses and malware as well as automated scanning of downloaded files. This is done through an arrangement with ESET a popular Anti-virus company. Epic says it provides anti-phishing protection via a bigger address bar with a bold domain name so suspicious can instantly determine if your on

a spurious site. Kind of stupid we feel. "Epic also warns users when they're about to visit a potentially dangerous website via a database of ratings on nearly 30 million websites from our partner the Web of Trust." says Alok. Image: epic scanning for viruses.png

Misceleanous look and feel

The look and feel is where the browser falls short. The browser window looks tacky with tabs that seem to be arranged with jagged edges. The whole window has resize buttons on all corners but won't maximise properly. The browser isn't designed for Windows 7 integration so doesn't snap to place when you drag the browser window to the top margin of your screen. Similarly no jumplists or superbar integration. Sure it's got the skins app that gives you access to thousands of skins or themes, many of which are India based. Yet, they look atavistic of something from a bygone area. Amongst other things worth reporting are the inbuilt Word processor and snippets app. The word processor is pretty basic but does autosave. Although the processor is rich text enabled, it saves only in txt format which is a downer. The snippets tool is a note taking application based on the popular Firefox addon called Scrapbook. It allows you to save scraps of text and images for later viewing. You can also label or tag notes for quick and easy recovery. The browser also gives due importance to Privacy. Epic has a one-click private data deletion button which also deletes long-lived Flash cookies - "the only browser that does so" points out Alok. Epic also has one-click private browsing mode in a new tab.

Performance

The browser is pretty fast but does require 10.5 secs on a fresh restart. There after it is comparable to any other browser of today. We tested it for certain parameters such as memory consumption and rendering tests such as the Acid 3 test. It did fairly ok. You can have a look at the scores table.

Overall verdict: A nice browser for those who want a distinctly Indian look and feel. Rating: 3 on 5 **d**